

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 416

By Lamar

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend the University of
Memphis Athletic Department.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing the University of Memphis (UM) Athletic Department, whose teams compete at the highest level of athletic competition as a National Collegiate Athletic Association Division I institution and a charter member of the American Athletic Conference (AAC); and

WHEREAS, UM Athletics currently has nineteen intercollegiate sports teams, and since joining the conference in 2013, has won thirteen AAC titles across all sports; and

WHEREAS, the 2024 Memphis Tigers football team, led by Coach Ryan Silverfield, won its fifth consecutive bowl game and recorded back-to-back ten-win seasons for the first time in program history; and

WHEREAS, the Memphis Tigers football team finished the season ranked No. 23 in the Coaches Poll and No. 24 in the AP Poll, marking the first time since 2019 that the Tigers ranked in either poll at season's end; and

WHEREAS, furthermore, the Tigers football team currently holds the longest active streak in the nation for scoring twenty or more points in forty consecutive games; and

WHEREAS, Memphis football either ranked or received votes in the AP Poll for ten weeks and the Coaches Poll for fourteen weeks during the 2024 season; and

WHEREAS, with eleven wins, Memphis football posted its first back-to-back double-digit-win seasons in program history and was 21-5 overall for the past two seasons, the most wins garnered in two years in Memphis's history; and

WHEREAS, Coach Penny Hardaway was duly named the 2024–2025 Coach of the Year by the AAC in recognition of his devoted instruction and success as the Head Basketball Coach at the University of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Coach Hardaway led the Tigers to a 26-5 overall record and a 16-2 mark in conference play on the way to Memphis's first regular season championship in the AAC and an AAC tournament championship as well; and

WHEREAS, the Memphis Tigers women's basketball team won its 425th game at Elma Roane Fieldhouse on February 1, 2025; the team's lifetime record in the Fieldhouse is 426-222, a winning percentage of .657; and

WHEREAS, the University of Memphis was one of two AAC programs to have three 1,000-point-scorers on its roster: Tilly Boler, DeeDee Hagemann, and Alasia Smith. All three Tigers accomplished this feat during the 2024–2025 season; and

WHEREAS, the Memphis Tigers football and men's basketball teams were both ranked in the AP Poll top twenty-five; seven Tiger football players earned First Team All-AAC honors, and three received Third Team All-AAC honors; and

WHEREAS, the men's tennis team received an at-large bid to compete in the NCAA Tournament; and

WHEREAS, for the third consecutive season, Memphis's women's soccer head coach and staff were named the South Region Coaching Staff of the Year by United Soccer Coaches; and

WHEREAS, both the Tigers men's and women's soccer teams won the AAC regular season championship in 2024; and

WHEREAS, the University of Memphis student athletes are also successful academically, with 94 percent of football players graduating and thirteen out of seventeen athletic teams scoring a perfect 1000 single-year APR score; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of the University of Memphis Athletic Department have not only made possible championship seasons but also surely bode well for future successes; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the students, coaches, and staff of the University of Memphis Athletic Department; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend the students, coaches, and staff of the University of Memphis Athletic Department and extend to them our best wishes for future success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.